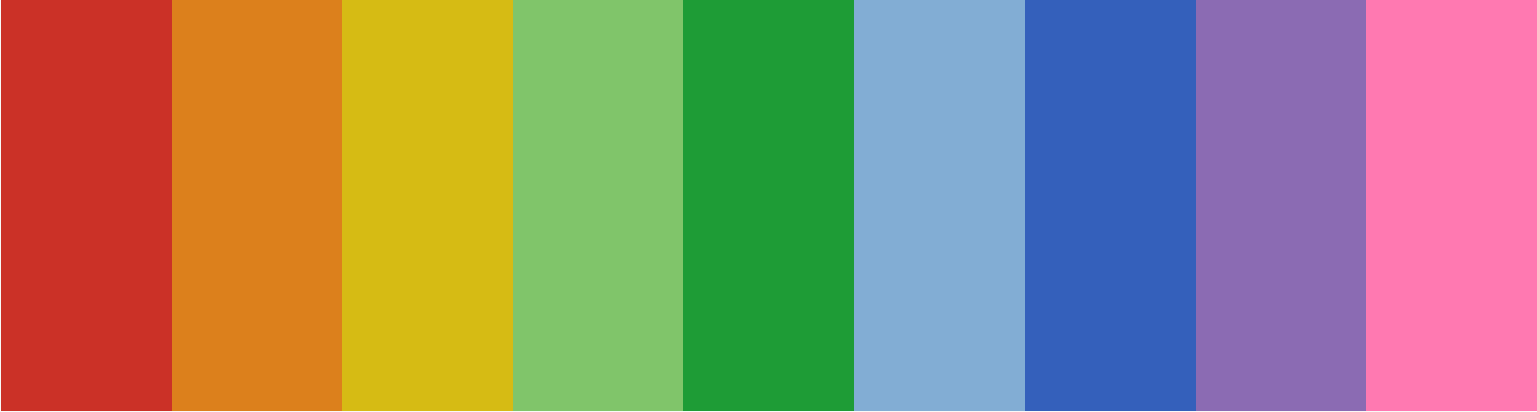




ENVIRONMENTAL DESIGN



INITIAL OBSERVATIONS

From our observation, my partner, June Mattson, and I noticed **messy and crowded drop off lines** of concerned parents, **lazy or unsafe drivers** on the road, and **imperfect infrastructure** around the school all leading to a decrease in students walking or biking to school. As more students faced danger due to a vehicle on their way to school, more parents opted to drive said students, thus increasing the number of cars on the road and further contributing to the problem.

We worked with the Transportation Agency of Monterey County (TAMC) to **plan and design new strategies decrease morning traffic, push safer driving practices, and encourage healthy activities for the youth.**



We noticed parents were often harder to reach due to a plethora of external responsibilities and might not be responsive. As a result we decided **our target audience to be to students**, choosing to give them the resources and support to build safer habits, and act as a vessel to amplify our reach. We still chose to target **other drivers on the road** as well in order to provide a well rounded strategy to create safer streets.

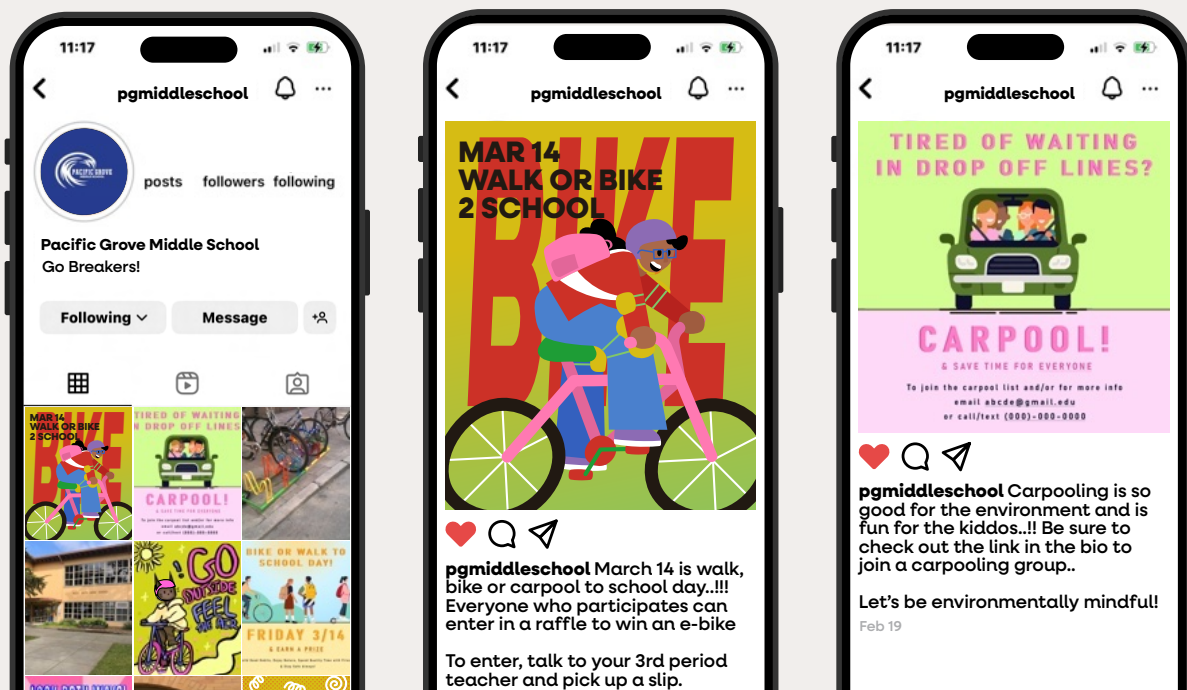


OUR STRATEGY

The design elements of **our plan is split into three phases** in order to **slowly get students and families used to changes** while also allowing **administrations time and space** to observe how effective the plan is without requiring them to put in too much money at one time. The first stage of the plan focus on **teaching students road rules**, the second focuses on **smaller environmental changes** and the final phase allows for **larger scale environmental alterations**. Most elements included in the plan are design related, however my partner, June, and I discussed other ideas to keep students and drivers involved and safe.

PHASE ONE

We begin phase one by focusing on educating students and parents who are willing to stay in the loop. **Social media and email campaigns** can remind people to be mindful, especially when there are children on the road. Social media platforms, like Instagram or Twitter, have a wide reach and can affect students, while email, or apps like Facebook, target parents. During this phase we also encourage the habit of walk/ bike/ carpool to school days, initially once a month, and increasing frequency over time. We can use social media/ email as an additional way to spread the message. Having dedicated walk to school days provides relief for parents as they know the roads will be less busy.



PHASE ONE (CONT.)

The second part of phase one relies on incidental or implicit learning. **Educational, infographic style posters** on classroom walls have proven to have a positive impact on student knowledge.



PHASE TWO

Phase two starts introducing minor changes to the school surroundings.

Unique road signs remind drivers that they are in a school zone, but the novelty wears off, but **interchangeable poster cases filled with student artwork** can be a feasible solution to that problem. Interchangeable poster cases bring a sense of novelty to the environment while being a source of pride for students whose to participate.



Additionally **painted bike racks, corrals, and paths** in easily accessible and visible locations would be a great measure to get students interested in biking and safe while doing so. This plays into fun theory while increasing general safety around school zones.



PHASE THREE

If the first two phases yield positive results, it would be effective to continue painting and brightening up the environment. **Painted crosswalks and murals** remind drivers there are young people in or around the area and encourage them to make safer choices on the road.

Both crosswalk painting and murals can be a **fun process involving, students, faculty and families**. Murals also contribute to a community's identity by visually representing its history, culture and values.



MISCELLANEOUS

Apart from the various artistic pieces that enhance the surrounding and educate students and drivers alike, my partner and I came up with other non design solutions that could yeild positive results.

1. **Assemblies and educational seminars** Many organizations can support schools by providing educational material that can be taught in classrooms or at larger scales.
2. **Stickers, toys or raffles** Small incentives can be a fun way to encourage students to participate in beneficial behaviors.
3. **Student traffic programs** Small, teacher run, student traffic programs in drop off zones allow students to be involved in keeping their school safe, while empowering students and teaching them valuable lifeskills.